providing network Critinext, revealed a reduction in infection, rehospitalisation rates and cost of care (saving Rs 30,000 on average per day per readmission).

According to Deloitte 2022 Global Consumer Trends in Healthcare, 74 per cent Indians prefer home sample collections, and 49 per cent prefer treatment at home. As with a spa experience or groceries, people want services and products to reach them. "Healthcare is no exception. Patients now expect healthcare to come to them—seamlessly, reliably and with the same standards as hospitals. So, the demand for home healthcare is accelerating across urban and semi-urban areas," adds Verma.

Rachit Kabra, 33, from Bengaluru availed homecare services from the start-up Harito. "They have physiotherapists, nurses, and caretakers for the elderly. They are my go-to provider for my father, who is a hemiplegic with regular physio and care requirements," he says.

Expectedly, India's homecare market is expected to touch Rs 1.82 lakh crore by 2027, compared to Rs 53,065 crore in 2020, according to projections in a 2021 report by NITI Aayog. According to business research consultancy HFS Research data, the CAGR (compound annual growth rate) for homecare is 19.3 per cent for India, more than double the 7.1 per cent for the US and the worldwide average of 7.9 per cent.

## BENEFITS OF HOMECARE

The first benefit of having a room at home converted into a hospital room is comfort. It helps reduce anxiety, loneliness and improves adherence to medical protocol. A report by market research agency Cyber-Media Research (CMR) revealed that home healthcare has the potential to replace up to 65 per cent of unnecessary hospital visits in India. From January 2019 to July 2021, out of the nearly 7,000 Indian critical care patients who chose to recover at home under the care of Portea Medical, only 7.5 per cent required re-hospitalisation. "Having your own bed, clothes, toilet is powerful in physical recovery," says Dr Akhil Srinivas, a general physician from Bengaluru. Indeed, the Follow Your Heart Program by Apollo Home, designed for patients who have undergone coronary artery bypass surgeries, saw 100 per cent medical compliance, improved sugar control and blood pressure.

The second benefit is that of cost. With no room rent, less hospital overhead costs and doctor consultations, home healthcare significantly reduces the financial burden of hospitalisation. The same Portea study found a 70 per cent reduction in medical costs. More importantly, out-of-hospital care until recently had limited health insurance cover. Today, Portea and HCAH offer cashless homecare services through tie-ups with over 40 insurers that include StarHealth, NivaBupa, ICICI Lombard and GoDigit.

## TECH & TRAINING

Advancing technology is the basis of the success of homecare. AI-enabled diagnostic devices like X-ray, ECG and CT scan machines mean that

# WHAT HOMECARE OFF

*The different services that come under the category*



**DIAGNOSTIC TESTS:** X-rays, ultrasounds, blood tests at home. AI-powered tests mean even those untrained in radiology can perform them

**PROVIDERS:** Apollo Home, Max@Home, Healthians
**COST:** Variable



**SPECIALISED PROCEDURES:** Treatments for injured limbs, home dialysis, injections, infusions, catheter management and post-operative recovery

**PROVIDERS:** Max@Home, Apollo Home, Seva at Home
**COST:** Variable



**ICU/ CRITICAL CARE:** For patients needing advanced medical care, specialised units with digital monitoring are set up at home

**PROVIDERS:** Max@Home, Apollo Home, Critical Care Unified
**COST:** From Rs 10,000 a day



**PALLIATIVE CARE:** For patients with long-term illnesses, focused on improving quality of life, managing symptoms

**PROVIDERS:** Pallium India, CanSure, Care24, Apollo Homecare
**COST:** From Rs 25,000 a month

**NURSING CARE:** Registered nurses for wound care, medication administration, personalised care plans, geriatric care



**PROVIDERS:** Portea, Emoha, Max@Home, Apollo Home, Seva at Home
**COST:** Rs 25,000 for 30 days of 24-hour care